The 6:15

THURSDAY · OCTOBER 15, 2026 NO. 26

THE BOARD

CALENDAR · NEXT 10 DAYS

Today	8:30a ET: September PPI, advance retail sales, initial jobless claims (wk. ended 10/10) — all due as scheduled, no shutdown risk (FY2027 funded via stopgap through Dec. 11). Tonight: Knicks preseason finale vs. Toronto, MSG.
Tue 10/20	Netflix Q3 results, ~1:01p PT / after the 4p ET close (confirmed via Netflix's own IR notice). Same day: Knicks open the regular season vs. Philadelphia at MSG, 7p ET, with a championship-banner ceremony.
Sat 10/24	Northwestern hosts Rutgers, Ryan Field.
Standing	FOMC Oct. 27-28 **(cut odds not independently re-verified this run after today's hot CPI — treat prior cycle-low readings as stale)**; OPEC+ next meets Nov. 1 (Nov. output already held flat at 31.01m bpd per its Oct. 4 decision); Nov. 3 midterms (Trump's no-strike-on-Iran pledge runs through that date); no frontier-AI release, rocket launch, or VC mega-round verified this run — fifth straight issue skipping this sub-bullet.

METRICS · ~6:05-6:10A ET; NO ICE/NYMEX SETTLE YET PRE-NY-OPEN

Oil / rates / dollar	Brent $103.71 (-2.22%, Yahoo BZ=F, 6:05a), down from yesterday's $106.2-106.4 morning range; WTI $93.63 (-0.29%, Yahoo CL=F, 6:07a), down from $95.21 yesterday. Spread ~$10.1, narrowed from ~$11.1. **Oil falling even as Hormuz escalates — see Lead.** 2Y 4.82% / 10Y 5.19% / 30Y 5.52% (Treasury.gov daily yield curve, Wed 10/14 close). DXY 102.03 (-0.51%, 6:08a).
Equities / vol / gold / gas	S&P 500 futures 7,747.00 (-0.30%), Nasdaq 100 futures 29,829.50 (-1.17%), both 6:08a — extending Wednesday's cash-session selloff (S&P -1.1%,

	Nasdaq Composite -1.9%, Reuters). VIX 17.55 (+4.04%, ~6:02a). Gold (Dec. future) $4,179.10 (+1.73%, 6:08a) — safe-haven bid. AAA national retail gas $4.3344/gal today, essentially flat vs. $4.3333 on 10/14.
Asia closes / Europe	Nikkei 225 64,425.95 (-4.90%, Yahoo); other wires put the same close at -4.8% to -5.4% depending on snapshot time **(not reconciled)**. Hang Seng 24,062.72 (-1.03%); Shanghai Composite 3,707.48 (-1.59%). Kospi fell roughly 8% intraday per Reuters — the session's biggest move **(single primary source, not cross-checked)**. Europe mid-session, delayed quotes, no timestamp given: FTSE 100 10,785.85 (+0.57%), DAX 25,207.17 (-0.36%), CAC 40 7,894.23 (+0.27%).

HORMUZ COUNTERS

Status	"Effectively closed to commercial traffic" per straits.live (15 Oct, 1021Z); Iran's IRNA claims passage still requires coordination with Iranian forces — CENTCOM has previously called that claim false **(continuity dispute, single-sourced framing)**.
Transits	2 on Oct. 11 vs. 85/day pre-crisis baseline (IMF PortWatch, via straits.live) — down from 4 on Oct. 4, the lowest reading of this cycle.
Strikes	No 24h count or running total published this issue; ABC News/ABC Australia describe attacks as having "reached their highest level since the start of the war," without a number **(vague)**. Named incidents don't reconcile: IRGC says tanker GFS Pride hit a mine, gCaptain's maritime-security sourcing says a projectile; Singapore's MPA reports two Singapore-flagged vessels hit by unknown projectiles; Bloomberg and CNN separately report container/cargo-ship sinkings straits.live itself says are not confirmed as linked. **(multiple uncorroborated claims)**
Dark tankers / war-risk	Not published this issue — straits.live's only vessel figure is 129 AIS-visible ships holding position as of 09:22 UTC, which excludes vessels near port and

	is *not* a dark-tanker count: a methodology change, not comparable to the 48/79.0 baseline reported previously. Crisis Pressure: "Extreme" band, flat 24h, now described as driven by transit deviation alone (no numeric score). Escalation Forecast: "High" band, flat 24h, Brent-WTI forward spread cited as top contributor (no numeric score). **Not comparable to issue No. 25's 88/61 scores.**

Methodology: transits (PortWatch, lagged by design), strike reporting (UKMTO/press, overlapping but non-identical windows), and the now-discontinued premia/dark-tanker series measure different things over different periods; never averaged or differenced here. All straits.live figures single-sourced.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees	Season over — eliminated Oct. 7, swept by the Rays **(continuity)**.
Knicks	Preseason finale vs. Toronto tonight at MSG; last confirmed record 0-2, games since not independently verified this run. Regular-season opener confirmed for Oct. 20 vs. Philadelphia at MSG (7p ET), with a 2025-26 championship-banner ceremony.
Northwestern	Bye week; 4-1 overall, 1-1 Big Ten. Hosts Rutgers Oct. 24.

LEAD

CPI · AI SELLOFF · OIL DECOUPLES

A hot CPI print cracks the AI trade — Kospi's worst day of the cycle, and oil falls even as Hormuz gets more dangerous, not less

September's CPI landed hot at 8:30a ET Wednesday: headline inflation rose 3.7% year-over-year (not seasonally adjusted), above a roughly 3.6% consensus, while core CPI (ex-food and energy) accelerated to 2.6% y/y from 2.4% in August. [NEW, fact, BLS] On a seasonally adjusted monthly basis, headline CPI rose 0.6% — up from August's 0.4% — while core rose 0.3%, matching August. [fact,

BLS] BLS attributed the headline surprise primarily to fuel prices; in one of the report's odder line items, candy and chewing gum prices rose 7.7% y/y on higher cocoa costs. [fact, secondary coverage, minor color]

The print did what hot CPI prints do to a market pricing a soft landing: it raised the implied cost of capital at the exact moment the index's single most expensive trade — AI infrastructure capex — has no margin for a higher discount rate. [read] The mechanism: a hotter-than-expected inflation path narrows the case for near-term Fed easing, which matters disproportionately to companies whose valuations assume both cheap financing for data-center buildout and uninterrupted hyperscaler demand. Asia opened into that repricing first and got hit hardest. The Kospi fell roughly 8% intraday, its sharpest move of this cycle, pulled down by Samsung Electronics (-9.9%) and SK Hynix and Kioxia Holdings (each down more than 11%) — the three firms most directly levered to AI memory-chip demand. [NEW, fact, Reuters via Euronext/Irish Times, single primary source for the Kospi figure] The Nikkei 225 closed down 4.90% (Yahoo), with other wires citing figures from 4.8% to 5.4% depending on snapshot time — not reconciled here. [fact/flag] Wednesday's US cash session already carried the move stateside: the S&P 500, which had set a record high only the week before, fell 1.1%, and the Nasdaq Composite fell 1.9%. [fact, Reuters] This morning's premarket shows no bounce — S&P futures -0.30%, Nasdaq 100 futures -1.17% as of 6:08a ET — while the VIX is up over 4% and gold has caught a safe-haven bid, up 1.73% to $4,179.10. [fact, Yahoo quotes, this morning]

What's conspicuously not moving in sympathy is oil, and that's the cross-asset tell worth sitting with. Brent is down 2.22% to $103.71

and WTI is down slightly to $93.63 this morning — even as the Hormuz situation on the Board got, if anything, more disordered overnight: IMF PortWatch's transit count fell to just 2 vessels on Oct. 11 (a new cycle low), ABC is describing strike frequency at its highest level since the war began, and straits.live is reporting disputed tanker incidents it says it can't yet reconcile. [fact, see Board] Two explanations are live, not mutually exclusive: either the market has already priced the supply-side Hormuz risk as high as it's going to go absent a confirmed production outage at Aramco (none has been confirmed, per this run's research — see Iran & Hormuz), or demand-side risk-off from the equity rout is simply outweighing the geopolitical premium for now. [read] Either way, a reader positioned for "Hormuz risk = oil up" needs to update: the correlation broke this morning. Watch today's PPI, retail sales and jobless claims at 8:30a for whether the inflation story broadens or was fuel-driven noise, and whether Friday's open sees Asia's chip-sector rout stabilize or extend into a second session.

POLITICS

Nothing new to add to the standing picture: Trump's Oct. 8 pledge not to resume strikes on Iran before the Nov. 3 midterms remains unretracted, and no shutdown risk exists before the Dec. 11 funding deadline (the stopgap, P.L. 119-103, is law) — both continuity, not news. **No dated reporting on midterm-specific developments was located this run — a gap, not a signal that nothing is happening.** One point from the CPI release worth filing here rather than in Economics: the report landed mid-campaign, where affordability has been a central midterm theme, and a hot print narrows the administration's room to claim cost-of-living progress before Nov. 3. [read]

ECONOMICS

Today's 8:30a ET trio — September PPI, advance retail sales, and initial jobless claims for the week ended Oct. 10 — will be read directly against Wednesday's hot CPI for whether the inflation surprise was broad or fuel-concentrated. [fact] No shutdown is constraining today's releases: funding runs through Dec. 11 under the enacted stopgap, resolving the risk flagged in prior issues. [continuity] Fed-cut odds for the Oct. 27-28 FOMC meeting were not independently re-verified this run; **treat any prediction-market reading from before Wednesday's CPI as stale**, since a hot print of this size typically moves cut odds down, not up. Separately, the 2026 Social Security COLA (2.8%) is circulating this week but is tied to Q3 data already baked into prior releases, not new this cycle. [continuity, minor]

BUSINESS

The Q3 big-bank cycle that opened Tuesday with Wells Fargo's beat and JPMorgan's miss (both continuity) effectively concluded Tuesday-Wednesday with a mixed finish. Goldman Sachs beat clearly: diluted EPS $17.01 against a consensus in the $13-14 range, net revenue $18.68bn. [fact, SEC 8-K] Citigroup beat too: adjusted EPS $2.85 against a $2.65 estimate, revenue $23.8bn (+8% y/y) **(non-GAAP adjusted figure per secondary reporting, not cross-checked against Citi's own GAAP line)**. Morgan Stanley beat: EPS $3.03 (vs. $2.80 a year ago), net revenue $20.3bn (vs. $18.2bn), ROTCE 22.6%. [fact, SEC 8-K] BlackRock beat on its preferred metric: adjusted diluted EPS $15.93 against a $14.30 consensus, AUM $15.49 trillion; GAAP diluted EPS was $10.57 — a wide GAAP/adjusted gap not further explained in anything found this run.

[fact, SEC 8-K] Bank of America was the one miss: GAAP net income $6.9bn, diluted EPS $0.91, after a $1.2bn regulatory settlement charge the company says cut EPS by $0.17; excluding that charge, adjusted EPS was $1.08 — below the roughly $1.11-1.19 range of pre-report estimates either way. [fact, SEC 8-K]

TECHNOLOGY

The session's defining technology story is the one in the Lead: an AI-capex repricing, not an AI-demand repricing, per market commentary found this run — Saxo Bank's Charu Chanana was quoted saying investors aren't questioning AI demand, only the cost of capital funding it. **(single analyst quote)** Samsung, SK Hynix and Kioxia bore the brunt in Asia on direct AI-memory exposure; US chip-adjacent names were not individually verified this run beyond the index-level Nasdaq move in the Lead. **(gap)** Separate reporting flagged growing concern over data-center financing structures — the debt and off-balance-sheet vehicles funding the AI buildout — as a second, related thread feeding the selloff, though specific figures behind that concern were not verified this run. No frontier model release was confirmed this run; claims of an Anthropic Opus 5.5 and OpenAI GPT-6 launch surfaced with conflicting dates and were not corroborated against an official source, so neither is reported as news here.

GEOPOLITICS

The Saudi-Houthi air war that produced the Riyadh airport strikes covered in recent issues has gone quiet in verifiable reporting since Oct. 12-13: that reporting had foreign carriers (Lufthansa, Air France-KLM, flydubai) still suspending or delaying Riyadh service, and Houthi threats to widen targeting to Aramco's Dammam headquarters, but no fresher, dated update was located this run. **(gap, not a resolution)** Aramco itself has not commented publicly on any production impact from the October strikes in anything found this run; the company's most recent public comment on Houthi impact ("no material impact on our capabilities") dates to August and predates this month's escalation, so it should not be read as current. **(stale)** OPEC+'s Nov. 1 meeting remains the next scheduled decision point on output, unchanged since the Oct. 4 hold.

IRAN & HORMUZ

Beyond the Board's counters, this morning's straits.live brief marks a visible change in what can be verified at all: the service stopped publishing numeric Crisis Pressure and Escalation Forecast scores (last seen at 88 and 61 in issue No. 25) in favor of unscored "Extreme" and "High" band labels, and it no longer publishes a dark-tanker count or war-risk premium, substituting a differently defined "AIS-visible vessels holding position" figure (129, as of 09:22 UTC) this brief will not treat as comparable to the prior series. [NEW, methodology flag] Substantively, the week's reporting is harder to pin down than usual: ABC's "highest level since the start of the war" framing for strike frequency carries no number, and the three-way dispute over how specific vessels were hit — IRGC mine claims vs.

gCaptain's projectile sourcing, Singapore's own confirmation of two of its flagged vessels being struck, and Bloomberg/CNN sinking reports that straits.live itself flags as unreconciled — means this issue can't respond with its usual single mine-vs.-projectile framing; there are several incidents, unresolved in parallel. [NEW, fact/flag] IMF PortWatch's transit count falling to 2 vessels on Oct. 11, down from 4 on Oct. 4, is this run's one measurable data point, and it points toward less traffic, not more, even as oil (per the Lead) is not pricing additional risk premium this morning. [fact, read]

SPORTS

Yankees	Season over; eliminated Oct. 7, swept by Tampa Bay in the ALDS.
Knicks	Preseason finale vs. Toronto tonight at MSG; last confirmed mark 0-2, interim results not verified this run; regular season opens Oct. 20 vs. Philadelphia with the championship-banner ceremony.
Northwestern	Bye week; 4-1 overall, 1-1 Big Ten; hosts Rutgers next, Oct. 24.

Continuity. The Riyadh/Aramco strike thread carries forward unresolved rather than updated — nothing dated past Oct. 12-13 was found this run, worth actively checking next issue rather than re-adjectiving. Straits.live's methodology change (no more numeric Crisis Pressure/Escalation Forecast scores, no dark-tanker count) is now in effect; next issue should confirm whether it's permanent. Fed-cut odds for Oct. 27-28 need a fresh read now that CPI has printed hot. Watch for next issue: today's PPI/retail-sales/claims trio; whether Asia's chip selloff extends into Friday's session; Knicks' actual preseason finale result and 2026-27 opener buildup; any confirmed Aramco production statement.

Unverified figures are marked in red above. Single- or secondary-sourced this issue: the Kospi's ~8% move; Nikkei's exact closing percentage (range 4.8%-5.4% across sources); all straits.live Hormuz figures including the new unscored bands and the AIS-visible-vessels count; the IRGC mine claim vs. gCaptain projectile sourcing on the GFS Pride; Bloomberg/CNN sinking reports, which straits.live itself says are not confirmed as linked; Citigroup's adjusted EPS; Fed-cut odds for the Oct. 27-28 FOMC meeting; Knicks preseason finale result. Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.